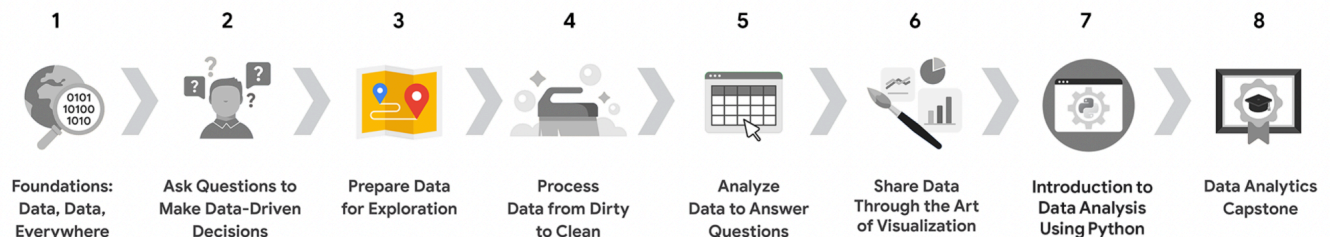




Reading: Course 3 overview

Welcome to the third course in the Google Data Analytics Certificate program! So far, you have been introduced to the field of data analytics and discovered how data analysts use their skills to answer business questions.

As you work through this course, you'll identify and explore different types of data and data structures that can be used to understand and respond to a business problem. Then, you'll learn to identify any bias in data and to verify its credibility. You'll keep adding to your data analyst tool box by further exploring data within spreadsheets and databases. Finally, you'll learn more about engaging with the data community and manage your online presence. All of these skills will come in handy, no matter where your career as a data analyst takes you.



1. **Foundations: Data, Data, Everywhere**
2. **Ask Questions to Make Data-Driven Decisions**
3. **Prepare data for exploration** (this course)
4. **Process Data from Dirty to Clean**
5. **Analyze Data to Answer Questions**
6. **Share Data Through the Art of Visualization**
7. **Introduction to Data Analysis Using Python**
8. **Google Data Analytics Capstone: Complete a Case Study**
9. **Accelerate Your Job Search with AI**

Course content

Each course in this program is broken into modules. Each one is designed to familiarize you with different data structures and show you how to collect, verify, and organize data. You will work on a wide range of activities that are similar to on-the-job tasks that data analysts come across on a daily basis.

Here's an overview of the skills you'll learn in each module.

Module 1: Data types and structures

A massive amount of data is generated every single day. In this part of the course, you will discover how this data is generated and how analysts decide which data to use for analysis. You'll also learn about structured and unstructured data, data types, and data formats as you start thinking about how to prepare your data for analysis.

Module 2: Data responsibility

Before you work with data, you must confirm that it is unbiased and credible. After all, if you start your analysis with unreliable data, you won't be able to trust your results. In this part of the course, you will learn to identify bias in data and to ensure your data is credible. You'll also explore open data and the importance of data ethics and data privacy.

Module 3: Database essentials

When you analyze large datasets, you'll access much of the data from a database. In this part of the course, you will learn about databases, including how to access them and extract, filter, and sort the data they contain. You'll also explore metadata to discover its many facets and how analysts use it to better understand their data.

Module 4: Organize and protect your data

Good organizational skills are a big part of most types of work, especially data analytics. In this part of the course, you will learn best practices for organizing data and keeping it secure. You'll also understand how analysts use file naming conventions to help them keep their work organized.

Module 5: Engage in the data community

Having a strong online presence can be a big help for job seekers of all kinds. In this part of the course, you will explore how to manage your online presence. You'll also discover the benefits of networking with other data analytics professionals.

What to expect

Each course offers many types of learning opportunities:

- **Videos** for instructors to teach new concepts and demonstrate the use of tools
- **Step-by-step guides** you can use to follow along with instructors as they demonstrate tools
- **Readings** to explore topics more in-depth and build on the concepts from the videos
- **Practice quizzes** to prepare you for graded quizzes
- **Graded quizzes** to measure your progress and give you valuable feedback

In this course, you'll be assessed with graded quizzes and activities. Both are based on the wide variety of learning materials and activities that reinforce the important skills you'll develop. And both can be taken more than once.

Tips for success

- It is strongly recommended that you go through the items in each lesson in the order they appear because new information and concepts build on previous knowledge.
 - Participate in all learning opportunities to gain as much knowledge and experience as possible.
 - If something is confusing, don't hesitate to replay a video, review a reading, or repeat a self-review activity.
 - When you encounter useful links in this course, bookmark them so you can refer to the information later for study or review.
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